

Also on one of these trips I formed a specific conviction that was to prove of tremendous dollar value to me a few years in the future. It was actually to lay the foundation for my business. One week we visited not one but two manufacturing plants that were located next door to each other in San Jose. One was the John Bean Spray Pump Company, the world leaders in the manufacture of the type of pumps that were used to spray insecticides on orchards to combat natural pests. The other was the Anderson-Barngrover Manufacturing Company, also world leaders, but in the field of equipment used by fruit canneries. In the 1920's the concept of a "growth company" had not yet been verbalized by the financial community. However, as I some-what awkwardly worded it to Professor Emmett, "I thought that those two companies had probabilities of growing very much beyond their present size to a degree that I had seen in no other company we had visited." He agreed with me.

Also, through spending part of the time on these automobile trips by asking Professor Emmett about his previous business experiences, I learned something else that was to stand me in good stead in the years ahead. This was the extreme importance of selling in order to have a healthy business. A company might be an extremely efficient manufacturer or an inventor might have a product with breathtaking possibilities, but this was never enough for a healthy business. Unless that business contained people capable of convincing others as to the worth of their product, such a business would never really control its own destiny. It was later that I was to build on this base to conclude that even a strong sales arm is not enough. For a company to be a truly worthwhile investment, it must not only be able to sell its products, but also be able to appraise changing needs and desires of its customers; in other words, to master all that is implied in a true concept of marketing.